Planning Module: Requirements for Development (Final)

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Author: Caroline Kinya Ikiriinya

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1. Scope and Purpose

The planning module is the foundational phase of the performance management platform. Built first for public institutions and adapted for nonprofits and for-profit enterprises, it enables an organization to build its annual plan from strategic sources, cascade it into departmental and unit workplans, generate individual performance contracts, and establish evidence requirements before operational execution begins.

Key Objectives in Phase 1

- **Multi-Source Planning:** Integration of multi-source planning objects (Strategic Plans, Board Directives, Government/Funder Mandates).
- **Flexible Org Structure:** Customizable chart configuration with adaptable vertical levels and horizontal branches.
- **Granular Workplans:** Departmental, unit, and program month-by-month workplans with mandatory evidence requirements.
- **Dynamic Performance Contracts:** Automated generation of Individual Performance Contracts dynamically linked to underlying workplans.
- **Governance & Workflows:** Workflow engine driven by each organization's approval charter or pre-built system templates.
- **Execution Visibility:** Complete coverage views, audit trails, and live execution status tracking.

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2. Platform Architecture & Core Pillars

The Performance Contract vs. Workplan Model

- **Workplans (Operational Timeline):** Detailed, month-by-month schedules maintained at the department, division, unit, or program level. They track specific activities, scheduled delivery dates, budget estimates, evidence requirements, and real-time execution status (Completed, In Progress, Overdue/Highlighted).
- **Performance Contracts (Individual Accountability):** Formal, high-level agreements generated for each employee detailing their strategic contributions, job description duties, and key performance indicators.
- **Dynamic Interlock:** While the performance contract outlines *what* an individual is responsible for across the year, it dynamically links to the underlying month-by-month workplans. Supervisors can view an individual's contract alongside the operational workplan schedule to track real-time delivery, pending outputs, and highlighted overdue tasks without cluttering the contract document with daily calendar dates.

Integrated Recommendations & Improvements

1. **Standardized Hierarchy & Workflow Templates:** To streamline setup, the system provides pre-configured templates (e.g., Civil Service Standard, NGO Grant-Funded Model) alongside the custom chart builder.
2. **Pre-Financial Clearance Gatekeeper:** The platform verifies that spending requests (memos) originate from approved workplan items before passing authorized data via API webhooks into external accounting systems (e.g., IFMIS, QuickBooks, SAP).
3. **Story Bank & Mandatory AI Source Attribution:** Evidence submitted against workplan items feeds the central Story Bank. AI-generated summary reports feature hardcoded attribution links; clicking any generated statement opens a side pane displaying the verified evidence source file and verification signature.

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3. Users and Roles

Role	Operational Responsibilities
Administrator	Defines organization type, sets up the org chart (or selects a template), assigns roles, and configures approval charter workflows.
Planner / M&E Lead	Manages the reporting year, uploads strategic plan sources, and compiles the overarching Annual Plan.
Department / Unit / Team Head	Establishes detailed month-by-month workplans, sets evidence requirements, and assigns program activities.
Supervisor	Agrees and reviews performance contracts, monitors real-time workplan delivery, and approves activity memos.
Employee	Confirms individual performance contracts, adjusts program contributions, and submits evidence against workplan activities.
Approver	Reviews and formally approves plans and contracts based on the organizational approval charter.

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4. Organization Chart Engine

- **Vertical Hierarchy:** Customizable levels (e.g., Board $\rightarrow$ Chief Executive $\rightarrow$ Directorate $\rightarrow$ Department $\rightarrow$ Division $\rightarrow$ Unit).
- **Horizontal Breadth:** Unlimited parallel units at any structural level.
- **Level Skipping:** Flexible branch paths (e.g., a Department having direct Units without intermediate Divisions).

- **Dynamic Restructuring:** Supports adding, removing, renaming, or moving units without losing attached workplans or historic data.

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5. Functional Requirements

Organizational Structure (OC)

- **OC-1:** Allow flexible vertical level definition.
- **OC-2:** Support unlimited horizontal unit placement.
- **OC-3:** Support branch level skipping.
- **OC-4:** Preserve attached workplans during chart reorganization.
- **OC-5:** Assign each individual to a single home unit with designated reporting lines.
- **OC-6:** Render interactive org chart visual diagrams.

Plan Sources & Annual Plan (PS & AP)

- **PS-1:** Record multiple plan source types (Strategic Plan, Government Mandate, Funder Agreements).
- **PS-2:** Define strategic objectives, indicators, baselines, and targets under each source.
- **AP-1:** Build the Annual Plan from tagged source items.
- **AP-2:** Cascade annual plan items to responsible departments, units, or cross-functional programs.

Workplans & Individual Performance Contracts (WP & IC)

- **WP-1:** Build detailed month-by-month unit/department workplans with activity schedules.
- **WP-2:** Tag activities as *delivering* or *supporting* annual plan objectives.
- **WP-3:** Consolidate unit workplans into comprehensive departmental workplans.
- **WP-4:** Set explicit evidence requirements and acceptance criteria for each activity.
- **IC-1:** Generate Individual Performance Contracts from assigned activities and job description duties.
- **IC-2:** Dynamically link Performance Contract items to month-by-month workplan schedules for live supervisor tracking (Done / Pending / Overdue Highlighted).
- **IC-3:** Maintain job description duties as a distinct non-strategic category.

Approval Workflows & Governance (AW, VC, BP)

- **AW-1:** Configure multi-step approval charters by role.
- **AW-2:** Audit trail and routing for Approve, Return, or Reject decisions.
- **VC-1:** Provide real-time supervisor views of individual contracts alongside workplan execution tables.
- **VC-2:** Flag unassigned or under-resourced activities.
- **BP-1:** Link financial estimates from approved workplans to finance memo clearance workflows.

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6. Release & Implementation Roadmap

1. **Stage 1 (Public Institutions):** Deploy core planning module, run internal integration testing, pilot with 10 public sector organizations.
2. **Stage 2 (Nonprofits):** Adapt funder-specific program structures, execute internal validation, pilot with 10 nonprofit organizations.
3. **Stage 3 (For-Profit Entities):** Finalize commercial unit structures, execute internal validation, pilot with 10 enterprise organizations.